NSF I-Corps
Customer Interview Form

NSF I-Corps Team:	**Team #003, Fruitful Network Development**				
Entrepreneurial Lead:	Dylan Montgomery	Mentor:		Faculty Lead:	

Customer Interviews

Market Segment:	**Agricultural Network: Farmer's Market Vendor/ Farm Owner**

Customer Name:	*Email:*	*Phone:*	*Date Contacted:*
Mike Massoli	WRENBOXFARM@GMAIL.COM	(330) 861-3012	04 /12 /2025
Company Name:	WREN Box Farms	*Job Title:*	Farm Owner

What 1 or 2 hypotheses are you trying to test in this interview? (Hypotheses are statements, not questions; they often start with "I think…")	**Market Validation (Speaking to industry individuals):** - **What are the current distribution needs and solutions for the AGNET** - **What are the current supply needs and solutions for the AGNET**
Use the space provided to list prepared questions, with space below each for notes, for your interview.	**Goals:** - **To understand the potential customer's top 2-3 problems** - **To understand the potential customer's current processes** - **To understand further downstream implications of the problem** - **To understand try to quantify the severity of the problem** - **To understand the limitations of the customer's current solutions** - **To understand the decision-making process** - **To understand what the current budget is for solving the problem** --- **Question:** - **What technological uses and costs (Website, Software, Service portals, Phones, Internet, Email, Hardware, POS, ect.)** - **What considerations are there in expanding operations?** - **What problems have you faced with short shelf life and fragile products?** - **How are internal operations challenged for a family farm (Software/hardware)?** - **And externally for family farms or other Network individuals?** - **Most costly part of being a vendor** - **How do you stay engaged** - **How have you found out about Markets and HUBs** - **What info do you wish you knew about suppliers** - **What do you wish people new** --- **Notes:** - **Currently sells leafy greens (Kale, Psinish, Green Onions, parsley) due to the season and winter greenhouse leftovers (Carrots)** - **Uses plastic packaging, interestingly enough** - **Very little concern for changing operations due to not wanting to bring on employees, however He said that his largest problem is time** - **Delivers their own CSA however they only really have a limited variety of produce so I am wondering if they would have greater success in running CSA's with other farmers or for a party entirely incharge of distribution.** - **Running their own CSA for five years now** - **I wish I could have talked longer, however I am suspicious about his dismissal of everything at every level being perfect, besides only having one hose.** - **He also did not have a very clear answer about his organic practices and told me that they don't use herbicide but they do use pesticides.** - **I wonder if his customers don't mind this or don't know this**

Notes:

- **I wonder if there is a side business to be had in serving CSA's, HUBS, and Farmers Markets Beeswax packaging, due to the public concern for this type of packaging, rather than plastic**
- **I am also wondering now about a buyer's consideration (be it for a farmer buying from a supplier or a customer of a vendor) for specific heirloom varieties.**
- **Even though his largest issue is for time, the couple that runs the farm also run their own CSA. So I am confused as to whether they are having trouble with improving operations, or income, or what. However he did say that their main goal for growth is getting a new hose for cleaning the produce as they only have one. How difficult could that be? But he also said that they have little to know about waste. It seemed as though they didn't have very much thought for change in any area, however I think this is due to the fact that he reports no waste whatsoever. I am sorta confused by this.**

What were the key things you learned from this conversation? Summarize your takeaways here.